

Chapter 3: Processes

Informally, a process is a program in execution. The status of the current activity of a process is represented by the value of the program counter and the contents of the registers.

3.1 Process States (simplified model)

In the simplified model used in this book, a process is always in one of three states: running, ready, or blocked. A blocked process is waiting for some event such as I/O completion.

3.4 Interprocess Communication

Cooperating processes require an interprocess communication mechanism.

Semaphores are integer variables accessed only through two atomic operations, `wait()` and `signal()`.